

Tomer Kadison

Backend & Platform Engineer · Observability & Data Infrastructure

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SUMMARY

Backend & Platform Engineer with 4+ years of experience building observability and data platforms in Unit 8200. Python expert with deep, hands-on ownership of the Prometheus / VictoriaMetrics / Grafana stack and strong Kubernetes experience. Was a core leading developer of a self-service monitoring platform used by hundreds of engineers, and later led a DevOps & platform team serving an entire data-engineering department. Creative and entrepreneurial by nature - takes initiative, optimizes workflows, and solves complex problems, repeatedly adopting and mastering open-source technologies end-to-end.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, TypeScript

Platform & DevOps: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Nginx, GitLab CI, Linux

Observability: Prometheus, VictoriaMetrics, Grafana

Data: Kafka, Elasticsearch, Temporal, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Spark, Flink, HDFS, Trino

AI tooling: LLM-assisted workflows across design, development, and testing (e.g., Claude Code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Engineer (Reserve Duty) | OSINT Division, IDF Intelligence | May 2026 - Jul 2026

- Optimized Palantir Foundry data transformations with Spark, Polars and DuckDB — introduced optimizations the team hadn't known were possible, cutting pipeline runtimes and costs by 70%
- Authored and delivered onboarding training — presentations and hands-on exercises published as a public learning site (tomerkadison.github.io/hafifot_osint)

Stack: Palantir Foundry, Spark, Polars, DuckDB, Iceberg, Parquet, Python

DevOps & Platform Team Leader | Data Engineering Department | Unit 8200 | Apr 2025 – Nov 2025

- Led a 3-person team owning all DevOps and internal platform development for a department of 200+ engineers processing large-scale geospatial and structured data
- Built self-service internal platforms around developers pain points, shortening common workflows from days to minutes
- Initiated and operated a department-wide Flink Kubernetes operator with Helm charts — replaced fragmented per-team operators with a single, developer-friendly solution owned by my team. Later started the same process with Temporal.
- Drove department-wide DevOps and observability standards, tracking adoption, FinOps, and technology usage through Grafana dashboards
- Operated the department's GitLab CI runners and a library of ready-made pipeline templates

Stack: Python, TypeScript, Kubernetes, Helm, GitLab CI, Flink, Spark, Airflow, Temporal, Elasticsearch, PostgreSQL, Trino, HDFS, Grafana

Backend Engineer | Monitoring & Observability Platform | Unit 8200 | Mar 2022 – Apr 2025

- Core backend developer of self-service observability platform used across the center - monitoring thousands of data-heavy system components and serving hundreds of users
- Designed and built the Python backend wrapping Prometheus, Grafana, and the full VictoriaMetrics stack: system-architecture modeling, metric-collection management, and complex alert-rule management
- Enabled out-of-the-box monitoring for 10+ technologies (Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis, Elasticsearch, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Hadoop, OpenShift, and more), researching each to define meaningful metrics and alert-rule templates
- Built the alert pipeline (filtering, deduplication, enrichment) and custom exporters - including one converting Elasticsearch log queries and aggregations into metrics
- Self-hosted and operated the entire monitoring stack on Linux servers and later Kubernetes, without official unit support; maintained Grafana for the whole center and worked in Go inside VictoriaMetrics internals

Stack: Python, Go, VictoriaMetrics, Prometheus, Grafana, Kafka, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, SQL Server, Nginx, Linux, Kubernetes, Docker

PROJECTS & OPEN SOURCE

- Docker Tar** — web app (deployed on GCP, later Azure) that lets anyone download Docker images as tar files from the browser, streamlining image transfer into air-gapped networks
- Goodman** — Chrome extension that detects terms-of-service and privacy agreements and uses an LLM to summarize them and flag red-flag clauses
- VictoriaMetrics** — community contributor: opened multiple GitHub issues documenting TSDB edge cases and limits, based on deep production usage

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Elite 8200 Data-Engineering Training Program ("Matmon") | Dec 2021 – Mar 2022

Intensive pre-military course: software development in Python and Java and a broad range of data technologies